



Business Development 101

Provides a structured 20-module execution framework covering **market analysis, sales operations, and sustainable growth tactics.**

Table of Contents

Business Development 101.....	1
Core Responsibilities.....	2
Typical BD Activities and Process.....	3
Key Metrics and KPIs.....	3
Skills, Roles, and Tools.....	3
How BD Differs by IT Vertical.....	4
Typical Deliverables from BD.....	4
Module 1: Verticals.....	5
Module 2: Motions.....	6
Module 3: Discovery.....	6
Module 4: Value Proposition.....	6
Module 5: Solution Mapping.....	7
Module 6: Offerings & Packaging.....	7
Module 7: Sales Playbooks.....	8
Module 8: Marketing & Demand Generation.....	8
Module 9: Partnerships & Alliances.....	8
Module 10: Pricing & Commercial Strategy.....	9
Module 11: Delivery & Customer Success.....	9
Module 12: Risk Management & Compliance.....	10
Module 13: Organizational Roles & KPIs.....	10
Module 14: Enablement & Tools.....	11
Module 15: Go-to-Market Roadmap.....	11
Module 16: Annexes & Templates.....	12
Module 17: Case Studies & References.....	12
Module 18: Metrics & Reporting.....	13
Module 19: Future Trends & Innovation.....	13
Module 20: Capstone & Integration.....	14



Business Development is the strategic function that creates long-term value for an organization by identifying, developing, and securing new market opportunities, partnerships, and revenue streams.

In IT-related industries (Banking, Insurance, Telecom, ITSM, SMEs, Learning Hubs) BD connects product and engineering capabilities to customer needs, shapes go-to-market motions, and drives sustainable growth through a mix of direct sales, partnerships, and product-led initiatives.

Core Responsibilities

- **Market Opportunity Identification** Scan markets for unmet needs, emerging trends, regulatory shifts, and technology adoption patterns that create openings for new products, services, or partnerships.
- **Account and Partner Acquisition** Target and qualify strategic accounts and channel partners (SIs, MSPs, cloud providers, ISVs). Build relationships that accelerate access to customers and shorten sales cycles.
- **Solution Definition and Packaging** Translate technical capabilities into vertical-relevant value propositions, packaged offers, and pricing models that address specific buyer pain points.
- **Deal Structuring and Negotiation** Design commercial models (SaaS, subscription, outcome-based, managed services), negotiate terms, and align legal, procurement, and finance stakeholders.
- **Pilot and Proof-of-Concept Management** Scope and run PoCs that prove value quickly, define success criteria, and create referenceable outcomes to scale adoption.
- **Cross-functional Enablement** Coordinate product, engineering, marketing, delivery, and customer success to ensure offers are deliverable, marketable, and supported post-sale.
- **Pipeline and Revenue Growth** Build and manage a qualified pipeline, convert opportunities, and drive expansion and renewals to maximize lifetime customer value.



Typical BD Activities and Process

1. **Research and Segmentation** Define ICPs by vertical, company size, tech stack, and regulatory exposure. Prioritize accounts and partner types.
2. **Outreach and Engagement** Run ABM campaigns, executive briefings, technical workshops, and partner co-sell motions to generate qualified meetings.
3. **Discovery and Qualification** Conduct executive and technical discovery to map business objectives, constraints, stakeholders, budget, and timeline.
4. **Solutioning and PoC** Co-design pilots with clear KPIs, data requirements, and acceptance criteria; deliver rapid time-to-value.
5. **Commercialization** Present TCO/ROI, finalize commercial terms, and secure procurement and legal approvals.
6. **Delivery Handoff and Expansion** Transition to delivery and CSM teams, run adoption programs, capture outcomes, and pursue upsell/renewal opportunities.

Key Metrics and KPIs

- **Pipeline Metrics:** Pipeline coverage, number of qualified opportunities, average deal size.
- **Conversion Metrics:** Lead-to-SQL, SQL-to-Opportunity, Opportunity-to-Close rates, win rate.
- **Revenue Metrics:** New ARR/NRR, expansion ARR, churn rate.
- **Velocity Metrics:** Average sales cycle length, time-to-first-deployment for pilots.
- **Customer Metrics:** NPS/CSAT, time-to-value, referenceable customers created.

Skills, Roles, and Tools

- **Essential Skills:** Strategic thinking, consultative selling, technical literacy, negotiation, stakeholder management, financial modeling, and partner management.
- **Core Roles:** Head of BD, Enterprise Account Executive, Solutions Architect/Pre-Sales, Partner Manager, Customer Success Manager, BD Operations.
- **Common Tools:** CRM (Salesforce), ABM platforms, CPQ, demo environments, ROI/TCO calculators, proposal automation, analytics dashboards.



How BD Differs by IT Vertical

- **Banking and Insurance:** Emphasis on compliance, security, long procurement cycles, executive sponsorship, and high-touch PoCs.
- **Telecom:** Focus on interoperability, network automation, partner ecosystems, and lab demos for technical validation.
- **ITSM:** Shorter pilots, outcome-based SLAs, and rapid adoption playbooks.
- **SMEs:** Price sensitivity, fast decision cycles, packaged offers, and self-serve onboarding.
- **Learning Hubs:** Content and platform bundling, L&D buyer personas, and measurable learning outcomes.

Typical Deliverables from BD

- ICP and account prioritization lists
- Vertical value propositions and battlecards
- Pilot/PoC plans and SOWs with success metrics
- TCO/ROI models and pricing proposals
- Partner programs and co-sell agreements
- Case studies, reference packs, and compliance documentation

--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--



Module 1: Verticals

Verticals defines key industry sectors along with their primary operational and technology priorities, covering Banking (compliance, modernization, and fraud detection), Insurance (claims automation and customer experience), Telecom (OSS/BSS modernization and 5G rollout), ITSM (observability and automation), SMEs (affordable cloud solutions and cybersecurity), and Learning Hubs (Learning Management Systems and certification tracking).

[Identifies market segments and their primary technology priorities.]

The target markets into six specific industry verticals, each defined by distinct operational priorities and technology focus areas:

Banking The banking sector prioritizes regulatory compliance to meet strict financial standards, modernizes legacy systems to improve operational efficiency, and deploys real-time fraud detection systems to protect customer transactions. (Focuses on regulatory compliance, legacy core modernization, and automated fraud detection.)

Insurance The insurance vertical centers its technology initiatives on automating claims workflows to reduce processing times and enhancing digital customer experiences to improve overall retention. (Prioritizes claims automation workflows and enhancing overall customer experience (CX).)

Telecom The telecommunications industry focuses on modernizing Operations Support Systems (OSS) and Business Support Systems (BSS) alongside driving infrastructure deployment for 5G network rollouts. (Centers on OSS/BSS modernization and 5G network rollout initiatives.)

ITSM IT Service Management emphasizes deep system observability across complex tech stacks and widespread operational automation to reduce manual IT support overhead. (Emphasizes system observability and operational automation.)

SMEs Small and Medium Enterprises target cost-effective digital transformation through affordable cloud services while establishing robust, fundamental cybersecurity defenses. (Target affordable cloud adoption and foundational cybersecurity protections.)

Learning Hubs Educational institutions and corporate training hubs center their strategy on robust Learning Management Systems (LMS) alongside integrated tools for certification tracking and analytics. (Focus on Learning Management Systems (LMS) and certification tracking tools.)



Module 2: Motions

Motions defines strategic go-to-market approaches tailored to specific buyer profiles, encompassing Enterprise motions characterized by long sales cycles and compliance-heavy requirements, SME motions driven by fast sales cycles and cost-sensitive purchasing, and Product-Led Growth (PLG) motions that leverage freemium models to spur viral adoption.

[Defines target customer engagement strategies based on buyer profiles]

Enterprise: Navigates long sales cycles driven by compliance-heavy requirements.

SME: Capitalizes on fast sales cycles catered to cost-sensitive buyers.

Product-Led Growth (PLG): Uses freemium tiers to foster viral product adoption.

Module 3: Discovery

Discovery establishes systematic engagement strategies to uncover and evaluate buyer requirements, leveraging techniques like executive briefings, interactive workshops, and structured questionnaires to identify essential outcomes including key customer pain points, regulatory compliance needs, and primary ROI drivers.

[Establishes structured engagement techniques to capture buyer needs]

Techniques: Conducts executive briefings, interactive solution workshops, and structured discovery questionnaires.

Outcomes: Pinpoints explicit pain points, regulatory compliance needs, and underlying ROI drivers.

Module 4: Value Proposition

Value Proposition defines how solution messaging is tailored to align directly with sector-specific priorities, combining compliance and legacy modernization for Banking, process automation and customer experience (CX) for Insurance, operational efficiency and technology innovation for Telecom, direct cost optimization for ITSM, price affordability for SMEs, and robust certification tracking paired with usage analytics for Learning Hubs.

[Aligns core value messages directly with industry-specific needs]

Banking: Pairs strict compliance controls with legacy system modernization.



Insurance: Combines claims automation with CX enhancements.

Telecom: Balances operational efficiency with technology innovation.

ITSM & SMEs: Delivers direct cost optimization and solution affordability.

Learning Hubs: Blends formal certification tracking with actionable usage analytics.

Module 5: Solution Mapping

Solution Mapping establishes a framework for aligning product solutions directly with vertical industry requirements, specifically mapping the products of Felixent to target customer needs. This framework relies on standardized reference architectures to guide technical deployments while emphasizing system modularity to ensure flexible, scalable growth across implementation environments.

[Translates client requirements into specialized architectural deployments]

Vertical Alignment: Maps Felixent product capabilities directly to industry-specific demands.

Architecture: Employs standardized reference architectures to guide implementations.

Design Strategy: Emphasizes system modularity to support customized growth.

Module 6: Offerings & Packaging

Offerings & Packaging defines the commercial structure and monetization strategies for product solutions, organizing services into tiered offerings across Basic, Pro, and Enterprise packages, incorporating modular add-ons for security, analytics, and customized SLA tiers, and providing flexible commercial options through subscription, per-seat, per-transaction, outcome-based, and managed services pricing models.

[Structures commercial product configurations and pricing channels]

Tiered Tiers: Provides tiered packages across Basic, Pro, and Enterprise levels.

Add-Ons: Offers modular upgrades for security, analytics, and elevated SLA tiers.

Pricing Models: Utilizes flexible options including subscription, per-seat, per-transaction, outcome-based, and managed services pricing.



Module 7: Sales Playbooks

Sales Playbooks outlines tactical execution strategies tailored to specific vertical requirements, incorporating a Compliance-first approach for the Banking and Insurance sectors, a Rapid Pilot strategy for ITSM and Learning Hubs, and a Channel Co-sell motion for Telecom and SME markets.

[Outlines tactical execution guides tailored to target account profiles]

Compliance-First: Tailored for high-governance sectors like Banking and Insurance.

Rapid Pilot: Designed for fast implementation within ITSM and Learning Hub environments.

Channel Co-Sell: Leverages strategic partner networks for Telecom and SME market penetration.

Module 8: Marketing & Demand Generation

Marketing & Demand Generation outlines the strategic framework for driving brand awareness and acquiring target customer pipelines through structured promotional tactics and aligned messaging. It deploys actionable marketing tactics including thought leadership, Account-Based Marketing (ABM), case studies, events, and digital campaigns to attract prospects, while centering overall campaign themes around key enterprise priorities such as compliance, cloud adoption, customer experience (CX), automation, and security.

[Drives brand awareness and pipeline acquisition across key themes]

Tactics: Deploys thought leadership content, Account-Based Marketing (ABM), case studies, industry events, and targeted digital campaigns.

Core Themes: Focuses campaign messaging around compliance, cloud capability, customer experience, automation, and security.

Module 9: Partnerships & Alliances

Partnerships & Alliances outlines strategies to expand market reach and accelerate go-to-market execution through ecosystem collaboration. It categorizes strategic partnership types into System Integrators (SIs), Managed Service Providers (MSPs), Independent Software Vendors (ISVs), cloud providers, and academic institutions, while establishing key program elements including partner



certification, deal registration, Marketing Development Funds (MDF), and structured partner enablement initiatives to drive channel growth.

[Expands market reach through ecosystem collaboration]

Partner Categories: Collaborates with System Integrators (SIs), Managed Service Providers (MSPs), Independent Software Vendors (ISVs), cloud providers, and academic institutions.

Program Framework: Features formal partner certifications, deal registration programs, Marketing Development Funds (MDF), and structured enablement.

Module 10: Pricing & Commercial Strategy

Pricing & Commercial Strategy establishes the commercial framework for value capture, contract structures, and deal negotiation tactics. It evaluates value-based pricing against cost-plus methodologies, sets key contractual terms governing data protection, intellectual property (IP), indemnities, and termination clauses, and structures discount incentives around volume commitments, multi-year agreements, and customer references.

[Balances profitability, deal structures, and legal compliance]

Pricing Strategy: Compares value-based pricing methodologies against standard cost-plus approaches.

Contract Terms: Establishes formal contract guidelines covering data protection, intellectual property (IP), indemnities, and termination terms.

Discount Structures: Implements incentives for volume commitments, multi-year contracts, and reference participation.

Module 11: Delivery & Customer Success

Delivery & Customer Success defines the post-sales engagement model designed to maximize customer value and drive account expansion. It outlines a structured lifecycle progression that moves customers from initial Onboarding to Adoption, Value Realization, and ultimately account Expansion, while tracking ongoing performance using key customer health metrics including time-to-value, adoption rates, Net Promoter Score (NPS), Customer Satisfaction (CSAT), and churn rate.



[Manages client relationships across the post-sale lifecycle to reduce churn]

Lifecycle Journey: Guides clients through

Onboarding → Adoption → Value Realization → Expansion.

Success Metrics: Measures effectiveness using time-to-value, adoption rates, Net Promoter Score (NPS), Customer Satisfaction (CSAT), and churn rate.

Module 12: Risk Management & Compliance

Risk Management & Compliance outlines the strategic framework for identifying potential operational risks and implementing governance controls to safeguard business continuity. It addresses key commercial and technical risks—including data privacy vulnerabilities, regulatory non-compliance, vendor lock-in, and complex system integration challenges—while establishing concrete mitigations through industry certifications like SOC2 and ISO27001, robust data encryption, regular security audits, and contractual Service Level Agreements (SLAs).

[Identifies commercial risks and establishes operational controls]

Risk Categories: Addresses privacy violations, regulatory non-compliance, vendor lock-in, and integration barriers.

Mitigation Controls: Enforces compliance via SOC2, ISO27001, data encryption, third-party audits, and contractual SLAs.

Module 13: Organizational Roles & KPIs

Organizational Roles & KPIs defines the team structure and measurement frameworks necessary to execute a business development strategy effectively. It establishes clear responsibilities across critical functional roles—including the Head of BD, Account Executives (AEs), Solutions Architects, Partner Managers, Customer Success Managers (CSMs), Marketing Leads, and Proposal Managers—while measuring operational success and organizational growth using key metrics such as quota attainment, renewal rates, campaign performance, and deal win rates.

[Defines team responsibilities and performance metrics]

Key Roles: Incorporates Head of BD, Account Executives (AEs), Solutions Architects, Partner Managers, Customer Success Managers (CSMs), Marketing Leads, and Proposal Managers.



Core KPIs: Evaluates performance via quota attainment, renewal rates, marketing campaign performance, and deal win rates.

Module 14: Enablement & Tools

Enablement & Tools provides the operational infrastructure and sales collaterals required to optimize go-to-market execution and accelerate the sales cycle. It utilizes an essential technology stack consisting of CRM systems, CPQ software, marketing automation platforms, dedicated demo environments, and performance dashboards, while equipping sales teams with critical enablement assets including competitive battlecards, ROI calculators, reference architectures, and customer case studies.

[Provides operational infrastructure and content assets to support field sales]

Tooling Infrastructure: Utilizes CRM systems, CPQ software, marketing automation tools, dedicated demo environments, and real-time dashboards.

Enablement Assets: Supplies competitive battlecards, ROI calculators, reference architectures, and client case studies.

Module 15: Go-to-Market Roadmap

Go-to-Market Roadmap outlines a structured, quarterly operational timeline for phased market execution and business expansion. It kicks off in Q1 by establishing Ideal Customer Profiles (ICPs), deploying Account Executives (AEs), and generating Account-Based Marketing (ABM) target lists; transitions in Q2 to launching pilot projects, securing anchor customers, and developing initial case studies; accelerates in Q3 by scaling demand generation initiatives, expanding channel partner networks, and leveraging client references; and finishes in Q4 by pursuing pricing optimization, driving customer renewals, and executing account expansion strategies.

[Schedules quarterly operational milestones for market rollout]

Q1: Formulates Ideal Customer Profiles (ICPs), deploys AEs, and builds ABM target lists.

Q2: Launches initial pilot projects, secures anchor clients, and publishes initial case studies.

Q3: Scales demand generation initiatives, expands channel partner programs, and leverages client references.

Q4: Executes pricing optimization, manages annual renewals, and pursues account expansions.



Module 16: Annexes & Templates

Annexes & Templates provides standardized operational resources and foundational reference tools designed to streamline sales execution and maintain consistency across business development workflows. It incorporates key annexes—such as Ideal Customer Profile (ICP) lists, compliance checklists, and pricing calculators—alongside reusable templates for Requests for Proposals (RFPs), pilot plans, ROI calculators, case studies, and Quarterly Business Review (QBR) decks.

[Provides standardized documents and reference materials for sales enablement]

Annexes: Maintains comprehensive lists for ICP definitions, compliance checklists, and pricing calculators.

Templates: Supplies standardized templates for RFPs, pilot project plans, ROI calculators, case studies, and QBR decks.

Module 17: Case Studies & References

Case Studies & References serves as the empirical validation layer of the business development framework, providing tangible proof of value creation, technical execution, and measurable ROI across target industry verticals. It synthesizes real-world client success stories, quantitative performance benchmarks—such as reduced time-to-market, operational cost savings, and high adoption rates—and technical reference implementations from previous deployments in sectors like Banking, Insurance, Telecom, ITSM, and Learning Hubs. By organizing customer testimonials, referenceable client rosters, and deep-funnel proof assets, this module equips go-to-market teams with authoritative social proof to de-risk buyer decision-making, validate compliance and performance claims, and overcome late-stage deal friction.

[Builds market credibility to accelerate closing velocity]

Case Study Structure: Standardized around Problem → Solution → Outcome.

Reference Program: Coordinates peer-to-peer customer calls and collects verified testimonials.

Strategic Value: Establishes market credibility, builds buyer trust, and facilitates faster buyer decisions.



Module 18: Metrics & Reporting

Metrics & Reporting establishes the analytical framework and data-driven governance required to measure, evaluate, and optimize go-to-market performance across the entire business development lifecycle. It defines essential quantitative indicators—including pipeline velocity, Customer Acquisition Cost (CAC), Customer Lifetime Value (LTV), win rates, expansion revenue, and net retention rates—while organizing them into real-time operational dashboards and executive scorecards. Furthermore, this module outlines structured reporting cadences, such as weekly pipeline reviews, monthly operational reviews, and quarterly strategic evaluations, ensuring cross-functional visibility, operational accountability, and continuous performance optimization across all sales, marketing, and customer success initiatives.

[Establishes key analytics to evaluate performance and pipeline health]

Core Metrics: Monitors pipeline coverage, win rates, average deal size, sales cycle duration, ARR growth, and churn rate.

Reporting Infrastructure: Employs CRM dashboards, Business Intelligence (BI) tools, QBR presentations, and scorecard tracking.

Module 19: Future Trends & Innovation

Future Trends & Innovation establishes the forward-looking framework required to anticipate market shifts, integrate emerging technologies, and sustain long-term competitive advantage across go-to-market strategies. It explores the adoption of transformative technologies—such as generative AI, hyper-automation, predictive analytics, edge computing, and advanced security models—while adapting sales and product strategies to changing buyer behaviors, digital-first procurement trends, and sustainability (ESG) priorities. Furthermore, this module outlines continuous innovation cycles, agile pilot experimentation, technology incubation frameworks, and strategic trend forecasting, empowering organizations to future-proof their value propositions, capitalize on market disruptions, and drive sustained revenue growth in rapidly evolving industries.

[Adapts strategies to emerging technologies and evolving buyer expectations]

Key Trends: Integrates AI enablement, predictive analytics, digital twins, blockchain, sustainability initiatives, and dynamic marketplaces.



Growth Drivers: Driven by demand for automated workflows, hyper-personalization, and Regulatory Technology (RegTech).

Module 20: Capstone & Integration

Capstone & Integration serves as the culminating synthesis of the entire business development framework, consolidating all prior concepts into a unified, end-to-end execution plan for market deployment. It integrates go-to-market motions, target value propositions, commercial packaging, risk mitigations, and operational roadmaps into a holistic strategy tailored for real-world scenarios. Through cross-functional alignment exercises, practical simulations, and comprehensive strategy reviews, this module validates operational readiness, ensures seamless coordination across sales, marketing, and delivery teams, and establishes a battle-tested playbook for driving scalable, repeatable, and sustainable revenue growth.

[Synthesizes all strategy components into a holistic business development model]

Holistic Integration: Merges verticals, sales motions, core offerings, playbooks, demand generation, alliances, commercial terms, delivery success, risk management, team roles, enablement assets, GTM roadmaps, case studies, metrics, and future trends.

Core Pillars: Success requires deep vertical specialization, scalable offerings, repeatable playbooks, transparent pricing, and robust risk mitigations supported by ongoing metrics and technology adoption.